

BERNERA NEWS

A Community Newsletter **The Daily Ceilidh**
in association with

BERNERA BRIDGE UPDATE

Statement from Comhairle nan Eilean Siar 4th September 2020

Following the weight limit restriction on the bridge serving Great Bernera, the Comhairle has established an internal Task Group who meet regularly to examine the implications on the community and monitor progress on the procurement of a replacement structure.



The picture is an illustrative example of a potential replacement bridge structure. The Comhairle is working with local contractors and UK suppliers of such a structure to determine the extent of works required and timescale for construction. Statutory processes may have to be followed which may add to the construction timescale, however emergency powers may be available to shorten these timescales. Confirmation of timescales will follow by press release.

The established Task Group has also been working with service providers and utility suppliers in order to minimise the impact on the local community. The recent bin collection exercise was a great example of a community pulling together and the Comhairle is extremely grateful for the commitment of all involved.

A solution to the supply of domestic heating oil is now in place and discussions with regards to gas supplies are taking place with the suppliers.

Local residents with any concerns are encouraged to contact the Comhairle through the customer helpline **(01851) 600 501**.

The Comhairle appreciates the continued patience of the local community.

Welcome to the 7th edition of the Bernera News. As I write this the wind is blowing, the skies are grey, and it really does feel as though Autumn has arrived in Bernera.

It's been a strange kind of year, but little things are helping to make life feel slightly more settled, even if it's not quite the normal that we know and recognise. Children and young people are now back to school; more health services are slowly starting to resume; and no longer are people panic buying toilet roll!

However, just as life was settling down, the news of the weight restriction on Bernera Bridge was announced. *See statement by council opposite...*

In other news, we at the Bernera News are currently looking into different ways to help fund the continued production of the newsletter. Our aim is to be able to produce and deliver a free copy to all households in the Bernera and Tir Mor area, in a similar format to what we currently produce. We want to continue to include a mixture of news and community announcements, as well as articles, quizzes, and interviews.

We are aware that people from outwith this area may be interested in reading a copy. Therefore, this month and next we have decided to trial making the Bernera News available to a wider audience, but with a charge to those not living in Bernera and Tir Mor.

Contact us at: 01851 600 159
Text/Whatsapp: 07958 549784
Email: hello@thedailyceilidh.co.uk
Or visit us online at:
www.thedailyceilidh.co.uk

BIN COLLECTIONS, RECYCLING AND COMMUNITY SKIPS

Firstly, a massive thank you to all who helped with the bin collection last month. The Comhairle have now taken delivery of a small refuse lorry. Residents are asked to present their bins for collection by 8am on Tuesday 8th September. As both non-recyclable and food and garden waste cannot be emptied at the same time with this vehicle please note that the lorry will visit your property twice, throughout the day, to collect each waste stream separately.



Both the recycling and Community Skip have now been relocated to Earshader.

BERNERA COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION

The Annual General Meeting of the Bernera Community Association will take place on Monday 28th September at 7.00pm

In view of the current Scottish Government restrictions on the numbers of people that can gather together, it is proposed that this year the AGM will be conducted "virtually", via an online meeting.

Anyone wishing to attend this meeting should contact either Ken Macaulay (Chairman) or Sue Long (Secretary) or email the Community Association at berneraca@gmail.com by the 16th September. Non-members are welcome to sign in.

SHOP NEWS



Over the next few days you will be hearing (or will have already heard) that I am giving up the shop.

I feel that now is the right time to move on and let someone else step in to provide shop and post office services in Bernera. Someone with energy, enthusiasm and the funding to do the things that I couldn't / can't do.

It is very early stages in this process, as this has only been decided in the last few days, but I have mentioned to a committee member that if the community would like to take on the businesses (not the premises) then they would have first refusal.

If this is not possible, then my next option is to sell as a going concern, including accommodation.

I will also consider just selling the shop business and the opportunity to become the next Bernera sub postmistress/master for a reasonable offer that reflects the 'goodwill' of both businesses.

Please be assured that everything will be as normal as possible until we arrange for another person / organisation to provide the same (or better) services for our customers.

We will not leave you without somewhere to buy your groceries and have access to post office services. You have all been amazing, particularly in this 'very strange' year, and I just feel that it is the right time to go out on a high.

It is with great sadness that I am choosing to move on as I really always thought that I would still be in the post office until I was (at least) 80 years old!! Thank you all for your support over the last 22 years and the previous 16 years with my Mum and Dad. I will endeavour to keep you updated regarding the sale of the business, as much as possible.

Kindest regards to you all

Aileen x

STORNOWAY CO-OP

Our local store in Macaulay Road, Stornoway, have extended their Vulnerable Shopper Home Delivery Service. The service was set up to help support customers who are either housebound or in remote areas and unable to visit the store during the current pandemic. If you consider yourself a vulnerable member of our community you can have your shopping picked and delivered for free.

All you need to do is email, or have a friend or family member email the store, with your shopping list, your name, contact number and address. Once your shopping has been processed they will call you for card payment over the phone. **(Please note it is very important that you check that it is the Co-op calling for payment before giving out your card details. We suggest either asking them to tell you what is on your bill, or asking to call them back on a number you know belongs to the Co-op)**

The store email address is **shop.6838@coop.co.uk** (If you would like any help emailing the store please don't hesitate to ask us here at the Daily Ceilidh if you do not have a family member or friend who can help)

EILEAN SIAR FOODBANK

Food boxes are still available for anyone needing them. If you or anyone you know is needing a food box please don't hesitate and contact the foodbank.

Telephone: **(01851) 706650**, email: **eileansiarfoodbank@gmail.com**, or PM us on Facebook

LANGABHAT MEDICAL PRACTICE

Unfortunately the volunteer delivery service for prescriptions is no longer available. Instead you will need to collect from the Breasclete Surgery during the following times:

Monday 2.30 - 5pm

Wednesday 1.30 - 5pm

Friday 11am - 12midday

Please remember to wear your face covering or mask and please allow 72 hours from ordering to collection.

On behalf of everyone in our community we'd like to say a big **THANK YOU** to all the volunteers from the Bernera Community Association for all their hard work delivering prescriptions until now.

BREAST SCREENING

The Breast Screening Programme, which was paused in March because of Coronavirus, is to resume later this year with a provisional date for Lewis scheduled for 20th October - 20th November.

Those who had been due to attend clinics that were cancelled will receive an appointment. All women are asked to keep to the appointment times specified on their appointment letter and to attend alone, unless they require an interpreter or carer. Anyone who receives an appointment they cannot attend, or who has any other questions, are asked please **DO NOT** go to the mobile unit but instead to call the Breast Screening Office on **(01463) 705416**.

Due to the constraints Covid-19 has placed on the service, it is unable to offer appointments to women over the age of 70 years for this year's visit.

TV LICENSING

In recent weeks TV licensing have started sending letters to anyone aged over 75 asking them to either pay for their TV licence or apply for a free one. Unfortunately scammers have been using this as a way of trying to get money from people. Colin sent us this information from Age UK.

TV Licensing will only ask you to pay using the following options:

By post using the address: TV Licensing, PO Box 578, Darlington DL98 1AN

Online at tvl.co.uk/75pay or tvl.co.uk/75apply **or** Over the **phone** on 0300 790 6151

If you are contacted and asked to pay for your TV licence using a different phone number, a different website or by posting your details to a different address you have been contacted by a scammer. TV Licensing have also been clear that they will not come to your doorstep to collect the licence fee if you are over 75, so anyone who claims to do so is also a scammer.

FLU VACCINATION 2020

This year, it is more important than ever to protect ourselves, our loved ones and our neighbours from the flu. The following groups are eligible for the flu vaccine this year:

- **All primary school children**
- **Children aged 2 to 5 (on 1 September 2020 & not yet in school)**
- **Anyone aged 55 and over**
- **Anyone with a health condition or living with someone who is shielding**
- **Pregnant women**
- **Healthcare workers & social care workers who provide direct personal care**
- **Unpaid and young carers**

The flu vaccine takes around 10 days to work and should help protect you from flu for around a year. Viruses change constantly so they can survive – this means that you should be immunised every year to make sure your body retains immunity to the flu virus. Each year, flu vaccines are produced which are a good match for the particular strain of virus circulating that year. Remember that the flu vaccine won't give you flu because there are no active viruses in the vaccine. After you have your flu shot, the area around the injection site might feel a little tender – keep moving your arm around, so it doesn't become stiff. You may also have a high temperature and some mild muscle aches for a few days – taking pain relief like paracetamol or ibuprofen (if you are able to) is usually enough to manage this.

Virginia Allum
Earshader

BERNERA BAKES... CARROT CAKE

Ingredients:

For the Cake: 60mls / 4 tablespoons corn or vegetable oil
8oz caster sugar
8oz finely grated carrots
6oz plain flour
1 ½ teaspoons baking powder
1 ½ teaspoons bicarbonate of soda
1 ½ teaspoons cinnamon
½ teaspoon salt
2oz chopped walnuts
2oz sultanas
3 eggs

For the Topping:

4oz cream cheese
1 teaspoon vanilla essence
2oz butter
8oz icing sugar

Method:

Beat the sugar and oil.
Add eggs, one at a time.
Add carrots, flour and other ingredients, beating well.

Bake in an 8 inch cake tin for 1 hour at Gas Mark 4, 180C or 350F. Leave to cool.

Topping:

Cream all ingredients together. Cut cake and sandwich ½ with cream mixture, leaving other ½ for spreading on the top.



Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost

POSTCARDS FROM THE ISLANDS... YOU'RE MOVING WHERE??

After our offer was accepted, we started telling our friends and family we were moving to the Isle of Lewis. This is pretty much how every conversation went:

Me: So, our offer has been accepted, we're off to the Isle of Lewis!

Them: That's great! Erm...Where's that then?

Me: Outer Hebrides.

Them: Is that Scotland?

Me: Yep, top left.

Them: Crikey. Bit chilly there. You sure? Why on earth would you want to go there??

Me: It's gorgeous, and milder than you'd think. Have you ever been?

Them: No, but are you sure you're sure? It's miles from anything, middle of nowhere really. Very lonely. Can't say I'd fancy it. Are you sure???

Seemed like the world was an expert on what to expect, despite their own lack of actual experience. We'd travelled in our camper up here for months, rented a house on the island in the middle of winter - we weren't experts by any stretch, but we'd done some research. We'd spent literally years saving up to make it possible, working long hours, not having big holidays, watching the pennies so that we could make the jump.



We were warned that lots of people move to the islands, and then move away again after a few months or after their first winter. But we're not city folk, we're generally solitary creatures who are happy with the company of a few good friends rather than a crowd of associates - and I think that suits this lifestyle well. Plus we love a good bit of weather, and that helps too!

After the move, naturally not everything went to plan. Things we thought we'd brought with us had been left behind, things we were sure we'd need stayed relegated to boxes for months (some are still unpacked after 3 years!), but in all the ways that mattered, everything went to plan.

We're still learning lots every day, still finding our feet and figuring out what works best, but we have zero regrets about moving up here. The Outer Hebrides is a beautiful place, and naturally we think Bernera is the best bit! It's a wonderful place to bring up a family and we look forward to continuing to invest in our home, our land, the island and our future. We made a lot of sacrifices to come here, moved away from friends and family, but you couldn't pay me to go back to the mainland now - I love it!

Claire Ritchie
Kirkibost



GENERAL KNOWLEDGE QUIZ

Answers from last issues quiz.

1. Argonauts
2. Mayflower
3. Tannadice
4. Methuselah
5. Delphi
6. Buffy
7. Savile Row
8. Gondola

9. Pluto
10. Borders Railway
11. Spanish Flu
12. Roger Taylor
13. A380
14. Flower Power
15. Crinan Canal
16. Offa's Dyke
17. London/Philadelphia
18. Karnak
19. Forces Sweetheart
20. Jaffa

21. Mullet
22. St Davids
23. Mortar Board
24. Pantheon
25. Pontifical Scots College
26. Capernaum
27. Blue / White
28. Taoism
29. Tuk Tuk
30. Olympic

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost



POSTCARDS FROM THE ISLANDS... CLEAN COAST OUTER HEBRIDES

Originally founded in 2017 when Janet Marshall, the current Chair, visited Eilean Glas on Scalpay and was horrified at the amount of plastic washed up on the shore. She got thinking and realised that this was replicated all around the islands, not just on the beaches, and sought ways to tackle the problem, especially on those shores not readily accessible from land.

"It is hard to ignore the fact that the shores of the Outer Hebrides are getting dirtier, with more plastics and more visible, and worryingly more invisible, pollution. My original aim was to do a little fundraising in order to charter boats to reach the less accessible shores. However, following my postings the response was so fantastic, so enthusiastic, and simply brimming with good ideas that I have set my sights a bit higher."

Since then CCOH has formed a team of local supporters and, in association with local communities, arranged 17 beach cleans, removing approximately 24 tonnes of marine waste. We've held several talks and public meetings, visited schools, cub and scout groups, held a Big Climate Conversation, and most recently a Mass Unwrap in a Stornoway supermarket. Charitable status was granted in 2019. Support has been received from several local, national, and international organisations to help with our various local projects.

Covid-19 has meant that, as the council are not currently supplying skips, community beach cleans cannot be held. However, CCOH are working behind the scenes getting ready for when restrictions are lifted.

What you can do now:

Join us. By becoming a member not only do you get invitations to events, an occasional newsletter, but also the knowledge that you are directly helping a local charity improve the area.

See our Facebook page or our website **www.cleancoastoh.com** or email us at **hello@cleancoastoh.com**

Mini beach cleans: Both the Marine Conservation Society and Surfers Against Sewage have information and advice about doing mini beach cleans under Covid-19 rules.

Terracycle: There are programmes to recycle items from specific manufacturers and items such as pens and pet food packaging.

Apps for marine litter: There are several apps for logging marine litter: Beach Track is Scottish based and can record marine animal strandings as well as litter; OpenLitterMap adds locations to photographs to record marine litter; Plastic@Bay are tackling marine pollution in NW Scotland and beyond by monitoring, researching, developing, recycling and proving educational outreach, they recently launched a Citizen Science portal.

Future Events:

Organised beach cleans: We are working with local communities and Comhairle nan Eilean Siar to start appropriately socially distanced beach cleans in the very near future, these will only be available to those on our mailing list and NOT the general public.

Big Boat Beach Clean: As funding has been received for an exploratory clean on less accessible shores via boats, we hope to start this soon. Spare places will be limited to paid up members.

Outreach: We are currently recruiting Community Ambassadors throughout the islands to help our team support beach cleans and more throughout the islands. Please get in touch if you can help at **hello@cleancoastoh.com**



Janet Marshall
CCOH



LEWIS AND HARRIS PLACE NAME WORD SEARCH

Bosta	Coll	Bernera
Uig	Rodel	Aird
Lochs	Tarbert	Balallan
Ness	Brenish	Gravir
Callanish	Valtos	Achmore
Hushinish	Tolsta	Stornoway
Scalpay	Bragar	Arnol

R	H	A	A	C	H	M	O	R	E	R	I	H	Y
L	S	R	I	N	T	A	R	O	D	E	L	U	C
O	I	E	T	E	T	A	R	B	E	R	T	S	L
C	N	N	C	S	L	O	N	R	A	R	S	H	L
H	A	R	A	S	S	C	A	L	P	A	Y	I	B
S	L	E	Y	A	W	O	N	R	O	T	S	N	R
R	L	B	D	H	T	T	B	A	L	S	H	I	E
N	A	H	R	S	H	A	B	N	H	S	A	S	N
R	C	H	L	I	L	N	V	D	O	N	A	H	I
A	A	N	V	A	V	U	A	T	R	T	L	R	S
B	A	G	L	S	R	A	L	T	S	G	I	U	H
L	N	L	A	A	I	A	R	L	S	R	S	N	L
A	A	L	H	R	V	S	O	G	H	O	A	D	E
N	C	O	L	L	B	T	A	I	R	D	B	O	I



Colin Halliday
Kirkibost

ON THE SOFA... JULIA SHAW



I have been teaching Yoga in Uig since 2004 and used to travel over to Bernera to take a class there as well. In 2014 I discovered Scaravelli-inspired Yoga. The slow, unhurried moves work deep into the joints, using breath as our guide.

Due to restrictions in place since the start of the Coronavirus pandemic, I have been offering online courses, meaning that none of us have to leave our warm cosy homes to feel the benefits, and with no driving home afterwards.

The classes are 1.5 hours long. After the first hour of movement, we have a short break then move into the relaxation phase. We practice breathwork, sometimes meditation and of course, lying still in Shavasana, the Relaxation pose. For the next 6 weeks we will be focusing on the upper back, rib cage, and ease of movement in the joints.

No experience of Yoga is needed. (If you are pregnant, please email me for guidance)

Classes are £8 per household, per session. No specialist equipment is required, just a yoga mat or a blanket, a pillow or rolled up towel, a yoga block or a cushion, an extra blanket and socks to keep warm during the relaxation, and some water to drink.

Classes are held using Zoom on Wednesday mornings 9.30 - 11am, and Thursday evenings 7 - 8.30pm.



For more information contact me by email: jshaw10209@aol.com or take a look at my website www.juliashawslowyoga.co.uk

In the next issue: On the Sofa with Kevin Long- The Island Plumber.

If you would like us to focus on your business, service, or any interesting activities you are doing, please get in touch

CERTAINTY

With the days beginning to get shorter we are becoming increasingly conscious of the seasons passing, albeit the randomness of the weather recently has surprised us on more than one occasion. Pleasantly, I should like to add.

Consulting weather forecasters such as XC Weather and the Met Office provides us with a predicted forecast of what the weather will be like today, tomorrow and perhaps with an increasing level of error, into the future. The uncertainty and volatility of weather patterns making it so difficult even for the most complex technology to accurately predict what the weather will be like.

Chance and predictability are very much the 'bread and butter' of Actuaries, who spend many years training and learning, using mathematical modelling to determine risk. The possibility, or not, of this or that happening. Widely used in commerce and insurance, these men and women's calculations and conclusions commit their companies to great financial exposure if their assumptions were to be wrong. They may be right but only time will tell and prove their predictions to be true.

And certainty is something many of us strive for continually, be that in terms of education, employment, finance, health and so on. Yet if there is anything the Covid 19 pandemic has highlighted for us is just how uncertain our world really is. No-one, including the world's biggest economies, or the greatest medical minds, were effectively able to instantly meet and overcome the demands and challenges presented by this pandemic.

A more devastating threat to the wellbeing of humanity, sin, has thankfully been spotted by and effectively overcome by God in Christ.

Sin may be a very small word; considered to be an archaic word in this modern era, yet, at the centre of this word lies the root of all of our problems. It may only contain 3 letters, but for humanity the middle letter, 'I', provides the answer to all of our woes, which is spiritual self-sufficiency.

To be spiritually self-sufficient requires one to live a life independent of God, our Creator. Such a life deprives itself of a life-long friend, as Jesus is denied access to love, comfort and fellowship with us along life's journey. The arrival of death presenting it with an impassable challenge. Yet God does not want us to be left comfortless, alone, or hope-absent in and at every stage of our lives here on Earth. God does not want to leave death to have the final Word when it comes to your life and my life, but provides us with a certain, unchanging, promise and solution to sin, *'for the wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord'*, **Romans 6:23**

Through repentance and faith in the blood of Jesus, every Christian believer has the certain guarantee of God's word that they are *'more than conquerors through Him [against all sin] who loved [them]'*,

Romans 8:37

Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



CHURCH UPDATE

Following the revision of Lockdown measures by the Scottish Government the Kirk Session of Bernera Church of Scotland met to discuss the re-opening of the Church.

The elders decided that the church should not re-open at this time, subject to review.

